

Mishcon de Reya

Complete firm and application research — programme structure, international growth, financial momentum, sectors, values, innovation, application tips and personal notes.

- Duration:** 6 years
- Outcome:** LLB (Hons) in Legal Practice
- University:** University of Law
- Location:** London
- Sectors:** Corporate, Dispute Resolution, Employment, Innovation, Private, Real Estate
- Structure:** 4 days work, 1 day study; SQE 1 & 2

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1. Programme Structure

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- First 4 years: 4 annual rotations
- Last 2 years: 4 rotations of 6 months each, alongside trainees
- 4 days of work, 1 day of study per week
- Work-based and online supervised study — requires self-motivation and discipline
- Leads to SQE 1 and 2, with ULaw assessments throughout

2. Firm Overview & Vision 2030

Founded in 1937 by one man over a shop in Brixton — the firm has shaped itself around culture, atmosphere and character from day one. Vision 2030 is centred around three increasingly entwined, connected sectors: **the Innovation Economy, Private Wealth and Capital, and Real Estate.**

While we've enjoyed 40% growth over the last five years, we've been at pains to make sure that as everything changes, everything stays the same.

— Firm statement

This is read as a signal that the firm's culture stays consistent even as it scales — not unpredictable or unsettled by rapid growth.

3. International Growth

- 2020 — opened a branch office in Singapore
- November 2021 — launched an association with Karas So LLP in Hong Kong
- Active regional presence in Saudi Arabia, with public discussion of further Middle East launches
- Described as pursuing strategic growth beyond London with clear global ambition
- Mishcon de Reya is a founding member of the newly launched Private Markets Forum (as reported by Investment Week)

4. Financial Momentum

Growth	Revenue has doubled since 2017; 40% growth over the last five years
2023/24 results	£302m revenue, £97m profit
What this funds	Litigation funding, technology development, global expansion

This financial strength is framed as giving the firm room to back ambiguity and riskier cases — for example ambitious litigation, start-up investment, and international joint ventures — with more room for reward as a result. The firm also balances this with public community work and public-impact litigation.

5. Clients & Practice Areas

Clients: private individuals, start-ups, corporates, and high-profile individuals.

ART LAW

REPUTATION PROTECTION

CREATORS & COLLECTORS

FAMILY BUSINESSES

REAL ESTATE

INNOVATION ECONOMY

PRIVATE WEALTH & CAPITAL

The firm's work is centred around three increasingly entwined and connected sectors: the Innovation Economy, Private Wealth and Capital, and Real Estate.

6. Family Business Values

- **Alignment** — helping achieve alignment between family members or branches of a family and, once aligned, between the family and management from outside the family; fundamental to a successful business
- **Purpose** — the business is treated as an outward representation of the family and its values; the firm works to ensure the business is best placed for the future in a way that stays true to that

- **Business Building** — recognises that family businesses tend to focus on long-term building rather than exiting, and the firm works alongside those driving the business as a guide, philosopher and friend

7. Firm Values

- Understanding — and better still, anticipating — the needs, aims and ambitions of clients
- A core belief that "business is personal"
- An entrepreneurial, tenacious and socially conscious spirit
- Has always embraced change to stay relevant and shape the future
- Client-savvy, engaged and responsive — genuinely understanding what the client wants

8. Innovation — MDR Lab & Legora

- **MDR Lab** — an in-house incubator helping start-ups build new legal tech tools; many alumni have raised significant funding (cited at over £100m), showing genuine investment in the success of other businesses, not just Mishcon's own
- A wider MDR Group has grown around this, including dedicated analytics and Mayfair-focused arms — extending beyond basic legal services into data and insight
- Strategically, this is about monetising legal insight and data — and changes how a trainee or apprentice gets exposure to innovation: hands-on and contributing, not just observing
- **Legora** — an AI tool used to streamline tasks; the firm's own team have discussed how AI is well-placed to take on lengthy, linear, costly legal tasks, freeing lawyers to focus on advisory work

Mishcon genuinely builds innovation, not just talks about it — from MDR Lab's start-ups raising over £100m to its new analytics and insights arm.
— Application note

9. Points of Tension

The firm has faced criticism in the past around aggressive defamation tactics, raising a genuine question of how to balance robust client advocacy with public interest and press freedom. Worth being aware of this tension rather than avoiding it — Mishcon's high-profile reputation management cases are a natural setting to discuss how that balance is actually navigated in practice.

10. "Shapers" & Apprentice Culture

- "Shapers" — not just someone with a vision, but someone who acts on it to make it a reality
- Being able to manage expectations; treating recruitment as a two-way decision, not just the firm assessing the candidate
- Enthusiasm is explicitly valued
- Apprentices describe picking up different working styles from everyone around them, aiming to become "the best of everyone around you"
- Trainees are involved in pro bono work, seeing real people and how the firm actually helps them
- A social mobility division supports access to the profession, including a "Careers Plus" event (organised by the social mobility committee) visiting sixth forms and colleges
- Determination is emphasised — not feeling disheartened when a door closes, and continuing to push until goals are achieved
- Described ethos: "people first, colleagues second"
- A strong events and energy culture; hard work is counterbalanced with culture, extensive training, and an internal academy
- Large business operations functions sit alongside the legal work — appealing for anyone with a broader interest in business, not just law

11. Application Tips (From the Firm)

1. Be clear on your goal, and why commercial law specifically
2. Be specific about clients, sectors, initiatives, and the Innovation/Technology/ESG-type themes the firm cares about (referred to internally as "ETI")
3. Be yourself
4. Hold yourself accountable — recognise that what every firm does differently actually matters
5. Watch "Hack the Case" on YouTube for preparation
6. Be curious
7. Emphasise the different types of clients the firm serves
8. Show commercial awareness
9. Recognise that everything in commercial law is interlinked
10. Remember it's not about regurgitating law — it's about partnering with and understanding businesses

1. Reference that Mishcon is a full-service firm
2. Note that it's a constantly growing firm
3. Emphasise volunteering experience
4. Reference the "Shapers" concept and general initiative
5. Mention the firm's "Little Law" newsletter
6. Non-legal work experience is explicitly valued (retail, hospitality, manual work, etc.) — for ongoing roles, state typical hours worked per week; describe your most recent role first

Word limits: roughly 150 words per work experience entry, and 150 words per activity/achievement entry (include start and end dates — for one-off awards, use the same date for both).

12. Recent News

- Simon Leaf and Tom Murray — worked in sports law at Mishcon, advising football players, F1 drivers and TikTok — went on to launch their own practice, Three Points Law, offering a more tailored and affordable service. Their stated view: the legal industry is primed for disruption, facing market pressure on rates that is making traditional advising more difficult
- Client expectations are changing — lawyers are increasingly expected to be advisors with legal expertise (i.e. strong commercial awareness), not simply interpreters of the law
- **Legora** is highlighted as streamlining tasks — AI can be used to cut fees, since law is well-placed to leverage AI for the most lengthy, costly, and linear tasks

13. Personal Fit & Application Angles

Drafted talking points and personal statement material connecting personal motivations and experience to the firm's positioning — for use/refinement in application answers.

Why Mishcon specifically

A strong personal connection to Mishcon's belief that "business is personal" — whether helping a family business align its values, or guiding a high-profile client through a dispute, it's about understanding people as much as law. Clients deserve nuanced, interpretative, personalised advice, which means understanding a client's external environment, internal expectations, and goals — not just applying legal principle. This has been practised on a smaller scale through running school tours for parents, learning to quickly identify different expectations and adapt tone and content accordingly.

Risk and reward mindset

Motivated by environments that turn uncertainty into opportunity — evidenced by taking on the Head of Marketing Team role at school: organising a team, holding meetings, and completely redoing the school's social media and brand presence, despite limited prior IT experience. The risk (potentially being unable to balance this with academics) was outweighed by the reward (strong communication skills, leadership confidence, and material for future applications). This mirrors Mishcon's own approach — backing complex litigation and start-up investment, informed by real financial strength rather than recklessness.

Supporting experience

- **Prezzo (front-of-house):** learned to treat clients as individuals with unique expectations, adjusting tone and communication accordingly; developed confidence, problem-solving and composure under pressure; built commercial awareness through upselling and exposure to a large business's inner workings
- **Law Ambassador:** helped younger students understand legal concepts by breaking down complex ideas; developed persuasive communication, adaptability, and the ability to think on your feet
- **Co-founded an informal debate club:** explored legal and ethical questions casually with peers (e.g. corporate veil, AI and legal decision-making); built persuasive argument skills and the ability to see both sides of a dispute
- **Retail sales role:** conducted one-on-one client appointments, learned that business success and human understanding go hand in hand — directly reinforcing that "business is personal"
- **Primary school volunteering:** built genuine relationships and understood the impact of being a consistent, positive role model — with an application pending for a Citizens Advice Trustee role

Sources: mishcon.com services, insights and careers pages; firm press coverage; published application guidance. Compiled as private research — verify current salary, deadline and programme details against the live listing before applying.